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YouTube sees a rise in ad
revenue to reach nearly
\$10B

YouTube continues to lead in the streaming market, with advertising revenue increasing by 13% year over year, according to Alphabet, Google's parent company, in its [second-quarter earnings report](#) released on Wednesday. This growth brings YouTube's total ad revenue to \$9.8 billion, up from \$8.7 billion in the same period last year.

The company slightly exceeded analyst expectations, which had forecast YouTube's Q2 ad revenue to be around \$9.6 billion.

For years, YouTube has been striving to capture a larger share of television ad dollars, especially as its popularity in TV has grown, accounting for a significant portion of its viewership. A [recent report from Nielsen](#) indicated that YouTube held the largest share of TV viewing for three consecutive months, representing 12.4% of the total audience time spent watching television.

In response to YouTube's success, rival streaming services, such as [HBO Max](#) and [Amazon Prime Video](#), have ramped up their advertising strategies, increasing ad placements to stimulate growth. Additionally, Netflix is emerging as a key competitor to YouTube, particularly after the company announced during its earnings call last week its intention to double its advertising revenue within the year. Although Netflix has not publicly disclosed its ad revenue figures, an analyst from Madison & Wall [estimates](#) that it's around \$3 billion.

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Overall, Alphabet reported strong results, with total revenue of \$96.4 billion in the second quarter, representing a 13% year-over-year increase.

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Lauren Forristal



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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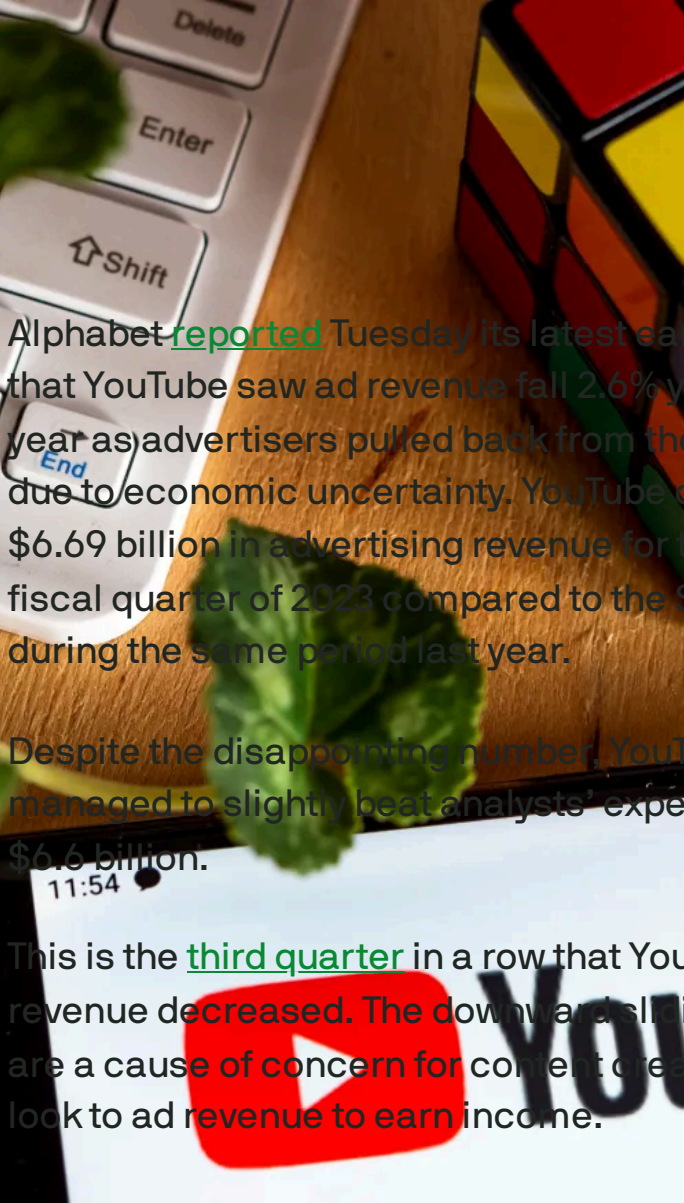
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YouTube continues to see ad revenue decline, 2.6% drop YOY



Alphabet **reported** Tuesday its latest earnings, citing that YouTube saw ad revenue fall 2.6% year over year as advertisers pulled back from the platform due to economic uncertainty. YouTube only raked in \$6.69 billion in advertising revenue for the first fiscal quarter of 2023 compared to the \$6.87 billion during the same period last year.

Despite the disappointing number, YouTube managed to slightly beat analysts' expectations of \$6.6 billion.

This is the **third quarter** in a row that YouTube's ad revenue decreased. The downward sliding figures are a cause of concern for content creators, who look to ad revenue to earn income.

The company attempted to offer reassurance during Tuesday's earnings call, choosing to focus on its success with the short-form video feature Shorts.

"Last year the number of channels that uploaded to Shorts daily grew over 80%. Those posting weekly on Shorts saw the majority of new channel subscribers coming from their Shorts posts," Sundar Pichai, CEO of Google and Alphabet said.

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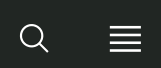
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YouTube also reiterated plans to ramp up its efforts to make YouTube more shoppable. The company [partnered with Shopify](#) last year to enable YouTubers and merchants to feature products on their channels.

“Shopping on YouTube... It's still super early days. One highlight last year, we brought shopping to more creators and brands by partnering with

commerce platforms like Shopify. Now more than 100,000 creators, artists and brands have connected their own stores to their YouTube channels to sell their products. We're excited about the potential ahead," Schindler said.

The company [confirmed to TechCrunch](#) in November that it plans to add shopping features to Shorts.

Overall, parent company Alphabet reported \$69.8 billion in revenue for the first quarter of 2023, a 3% increase from the same year-ago period.

YouTube CEO Susan Wojcicki [stepped down](#) from her role in February, taking on an advisory role across Google and Alphabet. Neal Mohan, chief product officer, is the new CEO.

In January, [Alphabet cut 6% of its workforce](#), which affected 12,000 employees.

[YouTube Shorts begins testing shopping features and affiliate marketing](#)

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YouTube gives advertisers new ad formats across Shorts

Lauren Forristal — 8:19 AM PDT · May 1, 2023

IMAGE CREDITS: 2023 IAB NEWFRONTS

As part of this year's YouTube NewFronts presentation, the company [announced](#) Monday that it's rolling out new ad formats to its short-form feature Shorts.

Of note, the company is expanding Shorts into its video reach campaigns.

[Video reach campaigns](#) use Google AI to improve reach by combining ad formats like skippable and non-skippable ads. With the update, advertisers can now upload a 60-second vertical video in order to reach engaged viewers.

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Previously, brands could only access Shorts inventory via Video action campaigns and App Install campaigns, which the company [announced](#) in 2022 during Google Marketing Live.

Paramount+ was among the early partners to test the latest version of video reach campaigns, YouTube wrote in its official blog post. The streaming service promoted its new movie, “At Midnight,” across YouTube’s in-feed, in-stream and Shorts ad experiences. According to YouTube, Paramount+’s recent ad campaign “drove higher efficiencies and higher ad recall” as opposed to only having in-stream ads, the company wrote.

Shorts currently attracts 1.5 billion viewers each month, the company said during its announcement, and Shorts are now seeing 50 billion views daily.

Separately, YouTube announced that it is expanding reach ads into the home feed.

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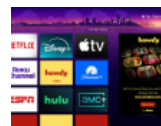
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Also, the company added that YouTube Select, its targeting solution for advertisers to pick out content packages and further connect with their audience, is coming to Shorts. This will enable brands to present ads alongside popular and relevant short-form videos. The Shorts lineup for YouTube Select will become available later this year.

Plus, YouTube is letting advertisers have their ad be the first a viewer sees after they start scrolling through Shorts.

[TikTok](#), a major Shorts rival, has [similar tools](#) for advertisers.

“As our viewers bounce between long-form videos and Shorts, discovering tons of new artists on the platform, they’re also discovering brands,” said Kristen O’Hara, VP of agency and brand solutions, during the NewFronts presentation. “Since we launched Shorts and video action campaigns last year, we have seen many, many brands really lean into how they can use Shorts.”

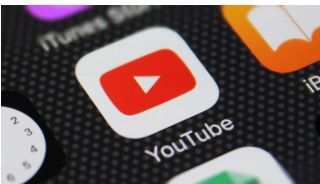
In its [latest earnings report](#), YouTube earned \$6.69 billion in ad revenue — a 2.6% drop year over year. While it was the [third quarter](#) in a row that ad revenue decreased, YouTube continues to focus on Shorts as its pride and joy. Earlier this year, Shorts reached [50 billion daily views](#).

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Google says YouTube Shorts has crossed 50 billion daily views



All social media companies are in a race to win the short video war and Google is showing some progress against TikTok and Instagram. The search giant said during its latest earnings call that YouTube Shorts has crossed 50 billion daily views. The company previously reported 30 billion daily views as part of its Q1 ... Continue reading

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